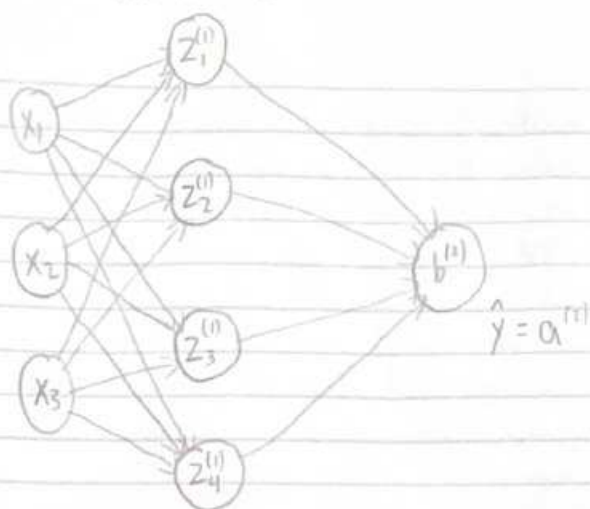


Activation:

$$h(a^{(i)}) = z_i^{(i)} = \tanh(a_i^{(i)})$$



$$W^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 3}$$

$$W^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times 4}$$

Dimension Verification Table:

| Operation                  | Left operand                          | Right operand                         | Result                                | Verification                                      |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| $a^{(1)} = W^{(1)}X$       | $W^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 3}$ | $X \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 1}$       | $a^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 1}$ | $(4 \times 3)(3 \times 1) \rightarrow 4 \times 1$ |
| $z^{(1)} = h(a^{(1)})$     | $a^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 1}$ | element-wise                          | $z^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 1}$ | element-wise $\rightarrow$ shape kept             |
| $a^{(2)} = W^{(2)}z^{(1)}$ | $W^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times 4}$ | $z^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 1}$ | $a^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times 1}$ | $(1 \times 4)(4 \times 1) \rightarrow 1 \times 1$ |

Weight initialization

$$W^{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.0191 & 0.4947 & 0.0718 \\ 0.3751 & -0.2048 & 0.7237 \\ -0.2023 & 0.5745 & -0.4695 \\ -0.9507 & 0.5477 & -0.1668 \end{bmatrix}$$

• Random seed: 20

$$\bullet W^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 3} \quad W^{(1)}: 4 \times 3$$

$$\bullet b^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 1} \quad b^{(1)}: 4 \times 1$$

$$\bullet W^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times 4} \quad W^{(2)}: 1 \times 4$$

$$\bullet b^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R} \quad b^{(2)}: 1 \times 1$$

$$b^{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$W^{(2)} = [-0.7209 \quad -0.7083 \quad -0.8148 \quad -0.9076]$$

$$b^{(2)} = [0]$$

Justification for hidden layer size:

I chose 4 hidden neurons because 3 input features is not very large so a smaller hidden layer is enough. The relationship between Sepal length, Sepal width and petal width is not a complex task, so a larger hidden layer may introduce unneeded parameters. 4 neurons is enough for the model to be flexible with non-linear patterns and lessen the risk for overfitting.

Forward Pass Calculations

data point:  $x = [5.1, 3.5, 0.2]^T$ ,  $y = 1.4$

Hidden layer pre-activations: compute  $a^{(1)} = W^{(1)}x + b^{(1)}$

$$W^{(1)}x = \begin{bmatrix} 0.0191 & 0.4947 & 0.0718 \\ 0.3751 & -0.2048 & 0.7237 \\ -0.2023 & 0.5745 & -0.4695 \\ -0.9507 & 0.5477 & -0.1668 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 5.1 \\ 3.5 \\ 0.2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5.1(0.0191) + 3.5(0.4947) + 0.2(0.0718) \\ 5.1(0.3751) + 3.5(-0.2048) + 0.2(0.7237) \\ 5.1(-0.2023) + 3.5(0.5745) + 0.2(-0.4695) \\ 5.1(-0.9507) + 3.5(0.5477) + 0.2(-0.1668) \end{bmatrix}$$
$$= \begin{bmatrix} 1.8432 \\ 1.3410 \\ 0.8851 \\ -2.9650 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$a_1^{(1)} = 0.0191(5.1) + 0.4947(3.5) + 0.0718(0.2) + 0 = 1.8432$$

$$a_2^{(1)} = 0.3751(5.1) - 0.2048(3.5) + 0.7237(0.2) + 0 = 1.3410$$

$$a_3^{(1)} = -0.2023(5.1) + 0.5745(3.5) - 0.4695(0.2) + 0 = 0.8851$$

$$a_4^{(1)} = -0.9507(5.1) + 0.5477(3.5) - 0.1668(0.2) + 0 = -2.9650$$

$$a^{(1)} = [1.8432 \ 1.3410 \ 0.8851 \ -2.9650]^T$$

Each  $a_i^{(1)}$  is the pre-activation for each  $i$ -th hidden neuron, which is represented by the weighted sum of the input features with the bias.

Hidden layer activations: Compute  $z^{(1)} = \tanh(a^{(1)})$

$$z_1^{(1)} = \tanh(1.8432) = \frac{e^{1.8432} - e^{-1.8432}}{e^{1.8432} + e^{-1.8432}} = \frac{6.15241}{6.47503} = 0.9511$$

$$z_2^{(1)} = \tanh(1.3410) = \frac{e^{1.3410} - e^{-1.3410}}{e^{1.3410} + e^{-1.3410}} = \frac{3.56128}{4.08445} = 0.872$$

$$z_3^{(1)} = \tanh(0.8851) = \frac{e^{0.8851} - e^{-0.8851}}{e^{0.8851} + e^{-0.8851}} = \frac{2.01055}{2.83590} = 0.709$$

$$z_4^{(1)} = \tanh(-2.9650) = \frac{e^{-2.9650} - e^{2.9650}}{e^{-2.9650} + e^{2.9650}} = \frac{-19.34314}{19.44626} = -0.9947$$

$$z^{(1)} = [0.9511 \ 0.872 \ 0.709 \ -0.9947]^T$$

Each  $z_i^{(1)}$  is the activated output of the  $i$ -th hidden neuron that is acquired by using the tanh function to its pre-activation  $a_i^{(1)}$ . The activation puts the neuron's response range into  $(-1, 1)$ , which introduces nonlinearity to the network.

Output layer computation: Compute  $a^{(2)} = W^{(2)} z^{(1)} + b^{(2)}$  and  $\hat{y} = a^{(2)}$

$$W^{(2)} z^{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} -0.7209 & -0.7083 & -0.8148 & -0.9076 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0.9511 \\ 0.872 \\ 0.709 \\ -0.9947 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$= [-0.7209(0.9511) - 0.7083(0.872) - 0.8148(0.709) - 0.9076(-0.9947)]$$

$$= [-0.9782]$$

$$\begin{aligned} a^{(2)} &= -0.7209(0.9511) + (-0.7083(0.872)) + (-0.8148(0.709)) + (-0.9076(-0.9947)) + 0 \\ &= -0.68565 - 0.61764 - 0.577693 + 0.9027897 \\ &= -0.9782 \end{aligned}$$

$$\hat{y} = -0.9782$$

$\hat{y}$  is the network's prediction for petal length. It is a weighted linear combination of the hidden layer outputs  $z^{(1)}$  with the output bias. Since the activation is linear, the network's prediction is equal to the weighted sum.

Loss Computation: Compute  $E = \frac{1}{2}(\hat{y} - y)^2$

Prediction error:  $\hat{y} - y = -0.9782 - 1.400 = -2.3782$

Squared error:  $(\hat{y} - y)^2 = (-2.3782)^2 = 5.6558$

Loss:  $E = \frac{1}{2}(\hat{y} - y)^2 = \frac{1}{2}(5.6558) = 2.8279$

The loss equation is  $E = \frac{1}{2}(\hat{y} - y)^2$ . The prediction error  $\hat{y} - y$  tells you how far the network's output is from the true target. Squaring halves the larger errors and  $\frac{1}{2}$  simplifies the derivative because  $\frac{\partial E}{\partial y} = \hat{y} - y$ , which is used in backpropagation.

Verification Table:

| Quantity  | Manual Calculation                       | Cell Output                            | Match? |
|-----------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------|
| $a^{(1)}$ | $[1.8432 \ 1.3410 \ 0.6851 \ -2.9650]^T$ | $[1.8434 \ 1.3413 \ 0.6851 \ -2.9651]$ | ✓      |
| $a^{(2)}$ | $-0.9782$                                | $-0.9782$                              | ✓      |
| $z^{(1)}$ | $[0.9511 \ 0.672 \ 0.709 \ -0.9947]^T$   | $[0.9511 \ 0.672 \ 0.709 \ -0.9947]$   | ✓      |
| $\hat{y}$ | $-0.9782$                                | $-0.9782$                              | ✓      |
| $E$       | $2.8279$                                 | $2.8278$                               | ✓      |

Output layer gradient derivation.

$$E = \frac{1}{2} (a^{(1)} - y)^2$$

Let  $u = a^{(1)} - y$ , so  $E = \frac{1}{2} u^2$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial u} \cdot \frac{\partial u}{\partial a^{(1)}} = \frac{1}{2} \cdot 2u \cdot 1 = u = a^{(1)} - y = \hat{y} - y$$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} = \hat{y} - y = -0.9782 - 1.400 = -2.3782$$

This gradient shows how sensitive the loss is to changes to the output  $a^{(1)}$ . A positive value means the output is too high and negative values means the output is lower than the target.

Gradient for  $W^{(2)}$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}^{(2)}} &= \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a^{(1)}}{\partial w_{ij}^{(2)}} & \frac{\partial a^{(1)}}{\partial w_{ij}^{(2)}} &= z_j^{(1)} \\ &= (\hat{y} - y) \cdot z_j^{(1)} \\ &= (\hat{y} - y) \cdot (z^{(1)})^T \\ &= (-0.9782 - 1.400) \cdot [0.9511, 0.672, 0.709, -0.9947]^T \\ &= (-2.3782) [0.9511, 0.672, 0.709, -0.9947]^T \\ &= [-2.2619 \quad -2.0738 \quad -1.6961 \quad 2.3656] \end{aligned}$$

Gradient for  $b^{(2)}$ :

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial E}{\partial b^{(2)}} &= \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(2)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a^{(2)}}{\partial b^{(2)}} = (\hat{y} - y) \cdot 1 = \hat{y} - y \\ &= (-0.9782 - 1.400) \\ &= -2.3782\end{aligned}$$

Error signal at hidden layer:

$$\delta^{(1)} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial z^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a^{(1)}}{\partial z^{(1)}}$$

$$\frac{\partial a^{(1)}}{\partial z^{(1)}} = W^{(1)}$$

$$\delta^{(1)} = (W^{(1)})^T \cdot \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(2)}}$$

$$\delta_j^{(1)} = w_{ij}^{(1)} \cdot (\hat{y} - y)$$

$$\begin{aligned}\delta_j^{(1)} &= [-0.7209 \ -0.7083 \ -0.8148 \ -0.9076] \cdot (-0.9782 - 1.400) \\ &= [-0.7209 \ -0.7083 \ -0.8148 \ -0.9076] \cdot (-2.3782) \\ &= [1.7144 \ 1.6845 \ 1.9378 \ 2.1585]\end{aligned}$$

The transpose  $(W^{(1)})^T$  is used so the dimensions line up correctly during the calculation. Each  $\delta_j^{(1)}$  represents how much the  $j$ -th hidden neuron influenced the output error.



Activation function derivative: Derive  $h'(a^{(n)})$  for  $\tanh$

$$\tanh(z) = \frac{e^z - e^{-z}}{e^z + e^{-z}} \quad \text{Let } u = e^z - e^{-z} \text{ and } v = e^z + e^{-z}$$

$$\frac{d}{dz}\left(\frac{u}{v}\right) = \frac{u'v - uv'}{v^2} \quad u' = e^z + e^{-z} \quad v' = e^z - e^{-z}$$

$$h'(z) = \frac{(e^z + e^{-z})(e^z + e^{-z}) - (e^z - e^{-z})(e^z - e^{-z})}{(e^z + e^{-z})^2}$$

$$= \frac{4}{(e^z + e^{-z})^2}$$

$$h'(z) = 1 - \tanh^2(z)$$

$$z_i^{(n)} = \tanh(a_i^{(n)}) : \quad h'(a_i^{(n)}) = 1 - (z_i^{(n)})^2$$

$$h'(a_1^{(1)}) = 1 - (0.9511)^2 = 0.0954$$

$$h'(a_1^{(2)}) = 1 - (0.872)^2 = 0.2396$$

$$h'(a_2^{(2)}) = 1 - (0.709)^2 = 0.4973$$

$$h'(a_4^{(1)}) = 1 - (-0.9147)^2 = 0.0106$$

$$h'(a^{(1)}) = [0.0954 \quad 0.2396 \quad 0.4973 \quad 0.0106]$$



Gradient with respect to pre-activations: Compute  $\frac{\partial E}{\partial a_i^{(1)}}$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial a_i^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial z_i^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial z_i^{(1)}}{\partial a_i^{(1)}} = \delta_i^{(1)} \cdot h'(a_i^{(1)})$$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} = \delta^{(1)} \odot h'(a^{(1)})$$

$$= [1.7144 \cdot 0.0954 \quad 1.6645 \cdot 0.2396 \quad 1.9378 \cdot 0.4973 \quad 2.1565 \cdot 0.0166]$$

$$= [0.1636 \quad 0.4036 \quad 0.9637 \quad 0.0229]^T$$

The Hadamard product  $\odot$  represents element-wise multiplication rather than matrix multiplication. The activation  $h'(a^{(1)})$  scales how much of the error signal is passed back through each hidden neuron.

Gradient for  $W^{(1)}$ : Derive  $\frac{\partial E}{\partial W^{(1)}}$  using the chain rule

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a_i^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a_i^{(1)}}{\partial w_{ij}^{(1)}} \quad \frac{\partial a_i^{(1)}}{\partial w_{ij}^{(1)}} = x_j$$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{ij}^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a_i^{(1)}} \cdot x_j$$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial W^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} \cdot X^T$$

$$= \begin{bmatrix} 0.1636 \\ 0.4036 \\ 0.9637 \\ 0.0229 \end{bmatrix} \cdot \begin{bmatrix} 5.1 & 3.5 & 0.2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.8344 & 0.5726 & 0.0327 \\ 2.0584 & 1.4126 & 0.0807 \\ 4.9149 & 3.3730 & 0.1927 \\ 0.1168 & 0.0802 & 0.00458 \end{bmatrix}$$

Gradient for  $b^{(1)}$ . Derive  $\frac{\partial E}{\partial b^{(1)}}$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial b_i^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a_i^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a_i^{(1)}}{\partial b_i^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a_i^{(1)}} \cdot 1$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial E}{\partial b^{(1)}} &= \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.1636 \\ 0.4036 \\ 0.9637 \\ 0.0129 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Complete chain rule example:

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{12}^{(1)}} = \frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a^{(1)}}{\partial z_1^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial z_1^{(1)}}{\partial a_1^{(1)}} \cdot \frac{\partial a_1^{(1)}}{\partial w_{12}^{(1)}}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{12}^{(1)}} &= (-2.3782)(-0.7209)(0.0954)(3.5) \\ &= 0.57245 \end{aligned}$$

Verification table:

| Gradient                                   | Manual Derivation | Cell Output | Match? |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------|--------|
| $\frac{\partial E}{\partial a^{(1)}}$      | -2.3782           | -2.3782     | ✓      |
| $\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{11}^{(1)}}$ | -2.2619           | -2.2619     | ✓      |
| $\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{12}^{(1)}}$ | -2.0738           | -2.0737     | ✓      |
| $\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{13}^{(1)}}$ | -1.6861           | -1.6861     | ✓      |
| $\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{14}^{(1)}}$ | 2.3656            | 2.3656      | ✓      |
| $\delta_1^{(1)}$                           | 1.7144            | 1.7145      | ✓      |
| $\delta_2^{(1)}$                           | 1.6845            | 1.6845      | ✓      |
| $\delta_3^{(1)}$                           | 1.9378            | 1.9376      | ✓      |
| $\delta_4^{(1)}$                           | 2.1585            | 2.1585      | ✓      |
| $h'(a_1^{(1)})$                            | 0.0954            | 0.0954      | ✓      |
| $h'(a_2^{(1)})$                            | 0.2396            | 0.2397      | ✓      |
| $h'(a_3^{(1)})$                            | 0.4973            | 0.4673      | ✓      |
| $h'(a_4^{(1)})$                            | 0.0106            | 0.0106      | ✓      |
| $\frac{\partial E}{\partial w_{11}^{(1)}}$ | 0.57245           | 0.5723      | ✓      |